

ERITREAN FOOD

[TIGRINYA TEXT: Megibi Ertra]

Bilingual Food Book
(Tigrinya-English)

Ages 3-7



[ILLUSTRATION: Traditional Eritrean
food spread on mesob/basket]

Daniel Tesfamariam

Discover Delicious Eritrean Foods!

ERITREAN FOOD / [TIGRINYA: Megibi Ertra]

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Written by: Daniel Tesfamariam

For Ages: 3-7 years

Language: Tigrinya & English (Bilingual)

NOTE: [TIGRINYA TEXT] placeholders indicate where
Ge'ez script translations will be added.

First Edition, 2025

ERITREAN FOOD IS SPECIAL!

[TIGRINYA: Megibi Ertra Fliuy Eyu!]

Eritrean food is one of the most delicious in the world!

We eat together from one big plate as a family.

We use our hands to eat - no forks or spoons needed!

Our food brings people together with love and joy.

[TIGRINYA: Full translation of introduction]

[Ge'ez script version to be added by Daniel]



[ILLUSTRATION: Family eating together
from a shared plate on a mesob]

INJERA

[TIGRINYA: Injera]

[FIDEL CHARACTER PLACEHOLDER]

Injera is our special bread.

[TIGRINYA TRANSLATION PLACEHOLDER]



Injera is a big, soft, spongy flatbread.

It is made from a special grain called teff.

We put all our food on top of the injera and eat together!

[TIGRINYA: Full translation in Ge'ez script]

For Parents:

Injera is eaten every day in Eritrea. It takes 3 days to make!

Have you tried this? Draw it!

[TIGRINYA: Ftinim-do? Sirahu!]



TSEBHI

[TIGRINYA: Tsebhi]

[FIDEL CHARACTER PLACEHOLDER]

Tsebhi is a yummy stew.

[TIGRINYA TRANSLATION PLACEHOLDER]

[ILLUSTRATION: bowl of rich stew]

Tsebhi is a delicious stew made with meat and spices.

It is cooked slowly until it is tender and full of flavor.

We scoop it up with pieces of injera - so tasty!

[TIGRINYA: Full translation in Ge'ez script]

For Parents:

There are many types of tsebhi - chicken (dorho), beef, and lamb!

Have you tried this? Draw it!

[TIGRINYA: Ftinim-do? Sirahu!]



SHIRO

[TIGRINYA: Shiro]

[FIDEL CHARACTER PLACEHOLDER]

Shiro is made from chickpeas.

[TIGRINYA TRANSLATION PLACEHOLDER]



[ILLUSTRATION: smooth chickpea stew]

Shiro is a smooth, creamy stew made from ground chickpeas.

It is spiced with berbere and has a warm, comforting taste.

Many children love shiro because it is smooth and mild.

[TIGRINYA: Full translation in Ge'ez script]

For Parents:

Shiro is one of the most popular foods during fasting days.

Have you tried this? Draw it!

[TIGRINYA: Ftinim-do? Sirahu!]



ZIGNI

[TIGRINYA: Zigni]

[FIDEL CHARACTER PLACEHOLDER]

Zigni is spicy and delicious!

[TIGRINYA TRANSLATION PLACEHOLDER]

[ILLUSTRATION: spicy red stew with meat]

Zigni is a spicy beef stew that is very popular.

It is made with lots of berbere spice and tomatoes.

The meat is cooked until it is soft and the sauce is thick.

[TIGRINYA: Full translation in Ge'ez script]

For Parents:

Zigni uses berbere spice, which is a special Eritrean spice mix!

Have you tried this? Draw it!

[TIGRINYA: Ftinim-do? Sirahu!]



HILBET

[TIGRINYA: Hilbet]

[FIDEL CHARACTER PLACEHOLDER]

Hilbet is smooth and tasty.

[TIGRINYA TRANSLATION PLACEHOLDER]

[ILLUSTRATION: smooth lentil dip]

Hilbet is made from lentils and is very smooth.

It has a mild, nice taste that children enjoy.

It is often served as a side dish with injera.

[TIGRINYA: Full translation in Ge'ez script]

For Parents:

Hilbet is very healthy because lentils have lots of protein!

Have you tried this? Draw it!

[TIGRINYA: Ftinim-do? Sirahu!]



FOOL

[TIGRINYA: Fuḷ]

[FIDEL CHARACTER PLACEHOLDER]

Fool is great for breakfast!

[TIGRINYA TRANSLATION PLACEHOLDER]

[ILLUSTRATION: bowl of mashed fava beans]

Fool is made from fava beans cooked until soft.

We eat it for breakfast with bread and sometimes eggs.

It gives us energy to start our day strong!

[TIGRINYA: Full translation in Ge'ez script]

For Parents:

Fool is a popular breakfast across East Africa and the Middle East!

Have you tried this? Draw it!

[TIGRINYA: Ftinim-do? Sirahu!]



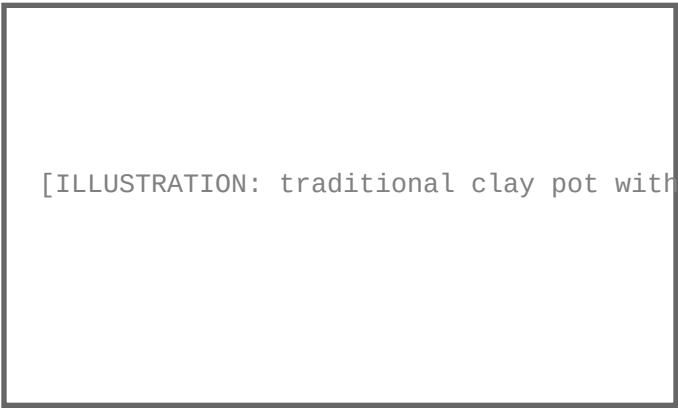
SUWA

[TIGRINYA: Suwa]

[FIDEL CHARACTER PLACEHOLDER]

Suwa is a traditional drink.

[TIGRINYA TRANSLATION PLACEHOLDER]



[ILLUSTRATION: traditional clay pot with drink]

Suwa is a traditional homemade drink from Eritrea.

It is made from grains and has been made for hundreds of years.

Adults drink suwa at celebrations and special gatherings.

[TIGRINYA: Full translation in Ge'ez script]

For Parents:

For kids: Parents can make a non-alcoholic version as a special treat!

Have you tried this? Draw it!

[TIGRINYA: Ftinim-do? Sirahu!]



HIMBASHA

[TIGRINYA: Himbasha]

[FIDEL CHARACTER PLACEHOLDER]

Himbasha is celebration bread!

[TIGRINYA TRANSLATION PLACEHOLDER]

[ILLUSTRATION: round decorated sweet bread]

Himbasha is a special sweet bread we bake for celebrations.

It has beautiful patterns on top and a slightly sweet taste.

We share himbasha at holidays, weddings, and happy gatherings.

[TIGRINYA: Full translation in Ge'ez script]

For Parents:

Himbasha has a beautiful design scored on top before baking!

Have you tried this? Draw it!

[TIGRINYA: Ftinim-do? Sirahu!]



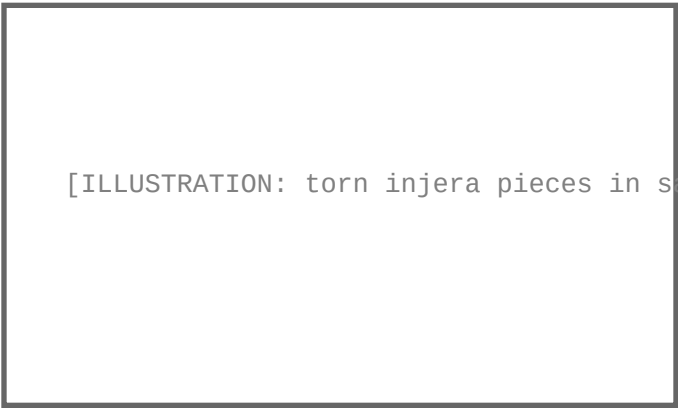
FIRFIR

[TIGRINYA: Firfir]

[FIDEL CHARACTER PLACEHOLDER]

Firfir is made with injera pieces.

[TIGRINYA TRANSLATION PLACEHOLDER]



[ILLUSTRATION: torn injera pieces in sauce]

Firfir is made by tearing injera into small pieces.

The pieces are mixed with spicy sauce and sometimes butter.

It is a great way to use leftover injera - nothing goes to waste!

[TIGRINYA: Full translation in Ge'ez script]

For Parents:

Firfir means 'to crumble' in Tigrinya - because we crumble the injera!

Have you tried this? Draw it!

[TIGRINYA: Ftinim-do? Sirahu!]



TEA WITH MILK

[TIGRINYA: Shahi bi Halib]

[FIDEL CHARACTER PLACEHOLDER]

We love our sweet tea!

[TIGRINYA TRANSLATION PLACEHOLDER]

[ILLUSTRATION: cup of milky spiced tea]

Eritrean tea is made with milk, sugar, and spices.

It smells wonderful and tastes warm and sweet.

We drink it in the morning and when friends come to visit.

[TIGRINYA: Full translation in Ge'ez script]

For Parents:

Tea time is important in Eritrea - it brings people together!

Have you tried this? Draw it!

[TIGRINYA: Ftinim-do? Sirahu!]



FOOD WORDS / [TIGRINYA: Qalat Megibi]

Delicious	[TIGRINYA: Tmuy]
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Hungry	[TIGRINYA: Tsemey]
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Eat	[TIGRINYA: Mblai]
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Cook	[TIGRINYA: Mstay]
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Share	[TIGRINYA: Mkataf]
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Family	[TIGRINYA: Sdra-bet]
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Bread	[TIGRINYA: Bani]
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Spicy	[TIGRINYA: Mririr]
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Sweet	[TIGRINYA: Miquy]
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Drink	[TIGRINYA: Mstay]
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Enjoy your Eritrean food! / [TIGRINYA: Megibi Ertra thmem!]